

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-24

Procurement Statement of Work and Source Selection Criteria

What the supplier must deliver, and how bids will be evaluated

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Procurement Statement of Work and Source Selection Criteria
Document reference	PMB-24-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager with procurement
Approver	Procurement authority and sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-23	Procurement Management Plan	Governs this procurement
PMB-08	Requirements Documentation and Traceability Matrix	Source of requirements
PMB-17	Quality Management Plan	Acceptance and quality standards

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Describes the goods or services to be procured in sufficient detail for suppliers to bid, and sets out the criteria and weightings by which bids will be evaluated and a supplier selected.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Procurement Management — Conduct Procurements
Created when	Before going to market
Reviewed / updated	Not changed after issue except by formal clarification to all bidders
Owner	Project manager with procurement
Approver	Procurement authority and sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Set the evaluation criteria and weightings before receiving bids, and record them here. Criteria adjusted after bids arrive are indefensible.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The statement of work describes outcomes and requirements, not the supplier's method
- Acceptance criteria are stated and measurable
- Evaluation criteria and weightings are fixed before bids are received
- Mandatory requirements are distinguished from scored ones
- Security and compliance requirements are included in the evaluation, not applied afterwards

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1. Procurement identity

Field	Detail
Procurement reference	PMB-24-HEL-T2-v1.0
Title	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Estimated value	AED 176,600,000
Contract type	Fixed price incentive fee
Route to market	Framework call-off with mini-competition
Issue date	18 Sep 2026
Bid return date	30 Jul 2027
Award target date	30 Jul 2027
Contract term	5 years including support

2. Background and context

Enough for a supplier to understand the environment. Be careful about disclosing sensitive detail before an NDA is in place.

Meridian Group operates fragmented AI compute across four departmental estates with an average GPU utilisation of 31% and annual public cloud GPU rental of AED 19.4m. Demand from AI Research, Fraud Analytics and the Retail division is growing faster than any single department can fund. Programme Helios consolidates that demand onto a single shared platform in DXB-1, scaling from a 256-GPU pilot to 4,096 GPUs across three tranches, with liquid cooling, a 400G RoCEv2 fabric, a multi-tenant orchestration platform and an MLOps stack.

3. Scope of work

Ref	Requirement	Type	Priority
SOW-01	Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence	Mandatory / Scored	M/S/C
SOW-02	Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception	Regulatory	Must have
SOW-03	Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence	Technical	Medium
SOW-04	Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board	Facilities	High
SOW-05	Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry	Security	Should have

4. Deliverables and acceptance criteria

Ref	Deliverable	Description	Acceptance criteria	Due
DAA-01	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Consolidate all AI training workloads onto a shared 2,048-GPU platform in DXB-1 halls A and B	Coolant leak alerts the NOC within 60 seconds and isolates the affected rack	25 Jun 2027
DAA-02	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response	Coolant leak alerts the NOC within 60 seconds and isolates the affected rack	18 Sep 2026
DAA-03	Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Self-service environment provisioning targeting a two-hour request-to-usable time	Storage sustains 1.2 TB/s against a representative training corpus for 30 minutes	15 Oct 2026
DAA-04	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Signed container image supply chain with admission enforcement and firmware attestation	Fair-share quota holds within 5% for each tenant under contention	30 Nov 2026

5. Service levels and performance measures

Measure	Target	Measurement method	Reporting frequency	Remedy for failure
Gate pack quality	85%	Gate pack quality	Per gate	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop
Forecast accuracy	Under 8%	Forecast accuracy	Per gate	Secure written migration commitments from three business units
RAID currency	95%	RAID currency	Monthly	Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order
Benefit measurability	100%	Benefit measurability	Quarterly	Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall
Assurance finding closure	Under 30 days	Assurance finding closure	Quarterly	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host
Dependency escalation lead time	Under 5 days	Dependency escalation lead time	Monthly	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026

6. Security, data protection and compliance requirements

State these as requirements to be bid against, not as terms to be negotiated at contract stage.

Ref	Requirement	Evidence required	Mandatory?
REQ-001	e.g. Certification against a recognised security standard	e.g. Current certificate and scope statement	Yes
REQ-002	The platform shall support both interactive notebook workloads and long-running distributed training jobs	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Partially
REQ-003	Training data classified as Restricted shall not leave UAE territory at rest or in transit	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Yes
REQ-004	All container images shall be signed and admitted only from the approved internal registry	ALM tool — Helios ART board	No
REQ-005	The fabric shall sustain at least 92% all-reduce efficiency at 256-GPU job scale	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Yes
REQ-006	The storage tier shall sustain 1.2 TB/s aggregate read throughput to the compute estate	Configuration management database	Partially
REQ-007	Users shall be able to self-serve a working training environment within two hours of request	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Yes
REQ-008	The platform shall expose per-tenant consumption data suitable for chargeback	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	No

7. Bidder response requirements

Section	Content required	Page limit	Weighting
Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	20
Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	Self-service environment provisioning targeting a two-hour request-to-usable time	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop	25
Secure written migration commitments from three business units	Signed container image supply chain with admission enforcement and firmware attestation	Engage vendor performance engineering for two	3

Section	Content required	Page limit	Weighting
		<i>weeks per hall</i>	
<i>Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall</i>	<i>Parallel filesystem tier of 12 PB usable sustaining 1.2 TB/s to the compute estate</i>	<i>Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover</i>	5

8. Source selection criteria

Weightings must total 100. Set before bids are received.

Criterion	Sub-criterion	Weighting %	Scoring method	Evaluated by
Technical solution	<i>Strategic contribution</i>	20	<i>Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build</i>	<i>M. Verity, Head of P3O</i>
Delivery approach and plan	<i>Regulatory or risk necessity</i>	20	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>	<i>L. Haddad, CISO</i>
Security and compliance	<i>Financial return</i>	15	<i>Dashboard published to the programme site</i>	<i>C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner</i>
Team and capability	<i>Deliverability confidence</i>	15	<i>Live walkthrough with a recorded session</i>	<i>M. Verity, Head of P3O</i>
Commercial	<i>Capability and resource fit</i>	10	<i>Workshop with the affected workstream leads</i>	<i>H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure</i>
Support and transition	<i>Dependency load</i>	5	<i>Dashboard published to the programme site</i>	<i>M. Verity, Head of P3O</i>

9. Scoring scale

Score	Descriptor	Definition
5	Excellent	Fully meets and exceeds the requirement with strong evidence
4	Good	Fully meets the requirement with good evidence
3	Acceptable	Meets the requirement with adequate evidence
2	Weak	Partially meets the requirement; material gaps
1	Poor	Does not meet the requirement
0	No response	Not addressed

10. Evaluation record

Bidder	Technical	Delivery	Security	Team	Commercial	Support	Total	Rank
<i>Nexora Integration Services</i>	4.3	4.5	4.1	4.4	3.8	4.0	84.6	1
<i>Arclight Systems Integration</i>	4.1	3.6	4.4	3.9	4.2	3.7	80.2	2
<i>Meridian Preferred Partner Consortium</i>	3.4	3.8	3.2	3.6	4.6	3.9	74.1	3
<i>Delta Cloud Services</i>	3.1	3.2	2.8	3.0	4.4	3.3	66.8	4

11. Award decision

Field	Detail
Recommended supplier	<i>Nexora Integration Services</i>
Score	3
Rationale	<i>Physical infrastructure has long lead times and low requirement volatility; the platform layer has short feedback loops and genuinely emergent requirements</i>
Conditions of award	<i>Performance bond of 10%, step-in rights, and design documentation held in escrow</i>
Approved by	<i>I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead</i>
Date	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>